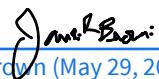


**James R. Brown**  
Jeanne & John R. Blocker Chair in Business Administration  
Professor and Department Head

## **MEMORANDUM**

**TO:** Boone Bowles, Assistant Professor, Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance

**FROM:** Jamie Brown, Head, Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance   
[Jamie Brown \(May 29, 2025 11:14 CDT\)](#)

**SUBJECT:** Annual Performance Review: January 1, 2024 – December 31, 2024

Both Texas A&M University and Mays Business School require that the performance of all faculty be reviewed on an annual basis. As noted in the Mays Faculty Promotion and Tenure Guidelines, the purposes of the annual performance review include:

- Creating a sound and logical basis for merit compensation recommendations
- Providing evaluative feedback regarding how well the individual is currently performing
- Providing developmental feedback regarding areas where the faculty member's contribution may be enhanced and/or improved in the future
- Providing feedback regarding progress toward promotion and/or tenure as relevant

Further, the Mays Faculty Promotion and Tenure Guidelines define four levels of performance for the key dimensions across which performance is reviewed. These levels of performance are:

- *Excellent performance*: a high level of performance that meets and exceeds norms and expectations and that is reflected by substantive indicators of *excellence*;
- *Effective performance*: performance that meets norms and expectations and that is reflected by substantive indicators of *effective* performance;
- *Needs improvement performance*: performance that falls below norms and expectations of *effective* performance as reflected by substantive indicators of *needs improvement* performance;
- *Unsatisfactory performance*: performance that falls below norms and expectations of *excellent*, *effective*, and *needs improvement* performance as reflected by substantive indicators of *unsatisfactory* performance.

This letter serves as your performance review for the 2024 calendar year. The following reflects information provided in your Faculty 180 submission. In addition, the tenured Finance faculty had the opportunity to review your annual report (containing detailed information about your research, teaching, and service) and current resume and provided me with their assessment and feedback. In the sections below, I first briefly summarize the main contributions you have made in each area, present the assessment of the tenured faculty, and provide my own independent assessment.

## Research

Highlights of your research activity during the three-year evaluation window include:

- A paper accepted for publication at the *Journal of Finance*, arguably the most prestigious outlet in finance.
- A favorable revise and resubmit at the *Journal of Financial Economics*.
- You completed multiple working papers that have been accepted for presentation at major conferences.
- You won a best paper award at the Southwest Finance Association conference.

## Teaching

- Excellent teaching across multiple preps. You developed a new class for the new Flex Online MBA program, in addition to continuing to teach an excellent class for the full-time program.
- You served on three PhD student dissertation committees.

## Service

- Faculty advisor of the business fraternity.
- Faculty advisor of a student men's organization.
- Ad-hoc referee for high quality finance journals.

## Tenured Faculty Assessment

As you will see below, all the of tenured faculty who reviewed your materials rated your research performance as excellent.

Last year, we observed that you needed to step up your efforts to get papers submitted more quickly. You seem to have taken our advice to heart, and we are happy to see that you got a paper accepted at the *Journal of Finance* and received an R&R at the *Journal of Financial Economics*. We also are encouraged that you have been submitting papers with some frequency. We urge you to continue doing so, and if possible, to increase the rate at which you submit papers.

In addition, to earn tenure, it is necessary that you demonstrate an independent ability to publish in leading journals. All of the papers you have had accepted or for which you received an R&R are with senior coauthors. It is essential that you demonstrate your ability to publish papers in leading journals that are either sole-authored or with coauthors at your level of seniority or lower. We see you plan to submit a paper authored with current or former TAMU Ph.D. students soon. We encourage you to prioritize this project.

The tenured faculty also unanimously rated your teaching as excellent. You taught an MBA class and a BBA class. Your teaching evaluations indicate a high degree of student satisfaction. We also see no evidence to suggest the high student satisfaction is coming at the expense of rigor, so we have every reason to believe you are teaching excellent courses. We further recognize the effort you put into developing a new class for the Flex Online MBA program. While we appreciate your achievements in teaching, we think that going forward you should budget relatively more time for research.

We are happy to see that for service, you are contributing the amount that is expected of an assistant professor on the tenure track. For this reason, the tenured faculty unanimously rated your service as satisfactory.

## Ratings (votes) from Tenured Faculty

**Research:** Excellent (9)

**Teaching:** Excellent (9)

**Service:** Effective (9)

**As a colleague:** Excellent (9)

**Overall:** Excellent (9)

Department Head Assessment

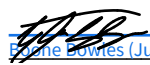
I agree with the assessment of the tenured faculty. You had an *excellent* year. Congratulations on seeing the *JF* in print and getting the new R&R at the *JFE*! You are in good shape for your mid-term review in Fall 2025, but of course your mandatory review in 2027-28 will be here before you know it. I fully support your (aggressive) goal of getting three of your completed working papers across in the finish line, including the *JFE* paper. If there is something the department can do to help you achieve this goal, I hope you will let me know! And while your primary focus should be on publishing your existing polished papers in the best outlets possible, please note the feedback from senior faculty on demonstrating an independent ability to publish in the leading journals. Toward this end, I encourage you try to keep the project you are working on with PhD students moving forward this year.

Your teaching contributions are exceptional, particularly for an untenured assistant professor.

Thank you very much for your contributions to the Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance and Mays Business School. It is a pleasure to work with you!

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Please acknowledge receipt of this evaluation by signing below. Note that your signature does not indicate your agreement with the contents of this evaluation.

  
Boone Bowles (Jun 3, 2025 11:26 CDT)  
Boone Bowles

06/03/2025  
Date

# Bowles 2024 Annual Review

Final Audit Report

2025-06-03

|                              |                                              |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
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